

KEEP THIS ONE; IT'S BUILT TO LIVE INSIDE YOUR GRADEBOOK

AI & Academic Integrity: Ask for One Thing AI Can't Hand In

THE WHOLE SESSION

Ask for one thing AI can't hand in.
And no accusation ever rests on a detector score alone.

Three places to find that one thing

This is the only list in the kit. Pick one place, write one sentence, add it to the assignment. You are not redesigning anything.

Place	What it means	Sounds like
1 · From this room	Something that happened here: Tuesday's discussion, the lab we ran, the text we annotated together, our own class data. A chatbot was never in the room.	"Use two claims from our Tuesday debate and name who made them."
2 · From this student	Their own reasoning, choice or experience, pushed specific enough that a generic answer cannot fake it.	"Which of your two drafts is better, and what did you give up to get there?"
3 · In front of you	A piece produced live. The timing is the security; nothing else has to change.	"Take two minutes at the board and walk us through where you got stuck."

The test: could a chatbot fake this? If the answer is "maybe, if the student described my class to it," push one notch more specific. If the answer is "only if it was in my room," you're done.

Ms. Rivera's assignment: the whole change, before and after

BEFORE · 7th grade English · persuasive essay · due Friday

Should our school day start later? Write a five-paragraph persuasive essay: an introduction with your claim, three body paragraphs with evidence, and a conclusion.

AFTER · the same sheet, one sentence longer

Should our school day start later? Write a five-paragraph persuasive essay: an introduction with your claim, three body paragraphs with evidence, and a conclusion.

Added, the one thing (from this room): "Use at least two claims from our Tuesday debate and name who made them. Then explain why the strongest counter-argument in the room did not change your mind."

Added, the one line about AI: "AI-assisted. Brainstorming and feedback are fine. The debate claims and your response to them have to be yours."

Why it works: a chatbot writes a school-start-time essay in four seconds. It cannot know what your third period argued on Tuesday. Asked to try, it leaves a blank or invents a claim, and you were in the room.

Your four steps

1. Put your next real assignment on the desk, written the way students will see it.
2. Name what it is actually for, in one sentence. Not the standard code: what do you need to see that you cannot see any other way?
3. Add the one thing AI can't hand in, from one of the three places above. One sentence.
4. Write the one line about AI, in words a twelve-year-old repeats back correctly.

Step 2 · What my assignment is actually for

Step 3 · The one thing AI can't hand in (circle the place: from this room · from this student · in front of you)

Step 4 · My one line about AI

About that one line: naming a level of allowed AI use is prior art, not ours. The AI Assessment Scale (Perkins, Furze, Roe & MacVaugh, 2024) is the published five-level version, from "No AI" to "AI Exploration," and it is worth reading if your school wants a full scale. We teach one line instead, because the assignment is the point.

When it still seems off: the conversation

Move	Say, or do
Open with curiosity	"Walk me through how you made this. What did you start with?"
Get specific	"Tell me about this paragraph. Why this claim and not the other one?"
Gather process evidence	The plan, the quick-write, the claims from your room, what they can explain out loud. You built this into the assignment.
Land it as teaching	First offense: name what was allowed on that assignment, reset, move on. A student who learns the rule beats a student who learns to hide.

The line that does not move: no accusation ever rests on a detector score alone. Not "mostly." Not "unless the score is really high." If a score is the only thing you have, what you have is a conversation to go start, not a case.

The numbers, with their scope

- **OpenAI's own classifier:** withdrawn after about six months citing "its low rate of accuracy." 26% of AI text caught; 9% of human writing falsely flagged (OpenAI, 2023).
- **Detector bias:** 91 TOEFL essays by real non-native English writers were falsely flagged by seven commercial detectors at an average 61.3%, while 88 US eighth-grade essays were classified near-perfectly (Liang et al., *Patterns*, 2023).
- **The rate did not spike:** at three high schools (one public, one private, one charter), anonymous self-reports of at least one dishonest behavior stayed relatively stable at roughly 60–70% before and after ChatGPT (Lee, Pope et al., 2024). Three schools and self-report, not national causal proof.
- **Why students do it:** Pope's research points at pressure, disengagement and workload far more than tool access (Stanford GSE, 2023).

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